

Soundtrack Changes Scene Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • The Arts • 20-30 min

Category	The Arts	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Easy	ID	soundtrack-changes-scene

Big idea: Artistic elements can guide emotion and interpretation before explicit evidence is considered.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students pair the same silent scene with different soundtracks and analyze how music changes interpretation.

Student Prompt

Inspect Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Scene: a person walks quickly down an empty corridor and opens a door. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Soundtrack Changes Scene Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass. Describe what you see or hear first, then add title/context and revise the interpretation.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Artistic elements can guide emotion and interpretation before explicit evidence is considered.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Soundtrack Changes Scene Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
6	How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to The Arts.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how artistic elements can guide emotion and interpretation before explicit evidence is considered.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?

Setup Checklist

- Use a simple silent scene with ambiguous emotion or intention.
- If audio playback is awkward, use written soundtrack cards instead of actual music.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- Scene: a person walks quickly down an empty corridor and opens a door.
- Soundtrack cards: playful pizzicato, tense low strings, nostalgic piano, triumphant brass.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/soundtrack-changes-scene/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/soundtrack-changes-scene/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/soundtrack-changes-scene/visual-prompt.svg>
- Scene interpretation chart: soundtrack, mood, story, evidence, confidence.
- Music feature cards: tempo, pitch, volume, rhythm, harmony, cultural association.

Run Sequence

1. Show the silent scene and ask students to infer mood and story.
2. Replay or describe the same scene with different soundtrack styles.
3. Students record how each soundtrack changes character, conflict, or expectation.
4. Groups identify which evidence came from the image and which came from sound.
5. Debrief emotion as a route to artistic knowledge.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: How does emotion shape interpretation in the arts?
- Can music make viewers know something that is not visually shown?
- Where is meaning located: in the work, the audience, or the combination?

Teacher Quick Script

- The visual evidence stayed constant; the emotional frame changed.
- What did the music make you expect before anything happened?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...